

Seattle Public Schools: Platform Logic Invited In

Public-source evidence packet for the K-12 school-delivery bridge. Scope: Seattle only; no CPRA request; no uploaded files used.

Pathway name	K-12 Invited-In Platform Logic Pathway
Owner function	Seattle Public Schools as the compulsory device, network, monitoring, and discipline authority.
Wrong absorbing box	Content filtering / online safety / digital citizenship / platform-only harm.
Control sentence	Seattle sued outward on the theory that platform companies harm vulnerable students through digital environments, targeting, unfiltered content, and potentially addictive properties; Seattle policy simultaneously shows inward delivery through district-issued devices, no opt-out/substitution, school network platform functions, student content/publication, incomplete filtering, monitoring, and discipline.

How to use this packet

This is not a CPRA packet. It uses Seattle Public Schools public web pages and a public news report to isolate the school-side bridge: district-required technology delivery, platform-like network functions, public-facing content pathways, incomplete control, monitoring, and discipline - paired against the district's outward lawsuit against social-media companies.

The purpose is to show school-side delivery and control. External sources support the architecture; they do not replace it.

Evidence matrix

Evidence item	Seattle public-source fact	Bridge finding
Device policy	Seattle states that each student is issued a district digital device; devices may be used for in-class instruction, assessment, assignments, or remote learning; students may be told to bring the device home and back. Source: 2022SP, lines 274-277.	This is district delivery of the digital environment, not ordinary private consumer use.
No opt-out / substitution	Seattle states district-assigned devices are used for classroom instruction, assignments, and assessments; because personal devices cannot be managed or supported on the district network, the district does not allow opt-out or personal-device substitution. Source: 2022SP, lines 294-296.	The pathway is compulsory or practically unavoidable for school participation.
Acceptable / unacceptable use	Seattle prohibits transmitting or accessing obscene, pornographic, graphically violent, or sexually inappropriate material for a non-educational purpose, and prohibits sexually explicit or gender-inappropriate jokes or messages. Source: 2022SP, lines 323-330.	Seattle acknowledges sexual/pornographic material as a known network-use risk inside the district electronic-resources pathway.
Student publication / content creation	Seattle permits creation of files, camera images, digital projects, videos, webpages, podcasts, and online publication of student work with parental permission. Source: 2022SP, lines 317-320.	This is identity, work-product, image, voice/content, and audience-facing infrastructure inside school.
Collaboration / social-network-like tools	Seattle defines its network to include email and Internet content including blogs, websites, collaboration software, social networking sites, and wikis. Source: 2022SP, lines 311-313.	Platform functions are invited into school operations, not merely encountered outside school.

Evidence item	Seattle public-source fact	Bridge finding
Monitoring	Seattle says staff must make reasonable monitoring efforts, the district may monitor student use on personal or district devices, and users have no expectation of privacy; the district may inspect files, applications, email, Internet access, and transmitted/received information. Source: 2022SP, lines 347-352 and 377-387.	Seattle claims inspection and monitoring authority over the pathway.
Filtering not foolproof	Seattle states filtering software is not 100 percent effective and that filters are not a solution by themselves. Source: 2022SP, lines 345-352.	The district requires/controls the pathway while acknowledging incomplete technical control.
Discipline consequences	Seattle states violations can lead to disciplinary action, including suspension or revocation of network/computer/electronic-resource privileges, school suspension, termination, and civil/criminal actions as warranted. Source: 2022SP, lines 408-410.	The school records and punishes consequences inside the pathway it required and monitored.
Outward social-media lawsuit	Seattle states it filed against companies operating TikTok, Instagram, Facebook, Snapchat, and YouTube; it says those companies created digital environments that negatively affect students and identifies increased screen time, unfiltered content, and potentially addictive properties of social media. Source: SPS Social Media Case, lines 268-299.	Seattle admits the platform-harm logic outward while district records show inward platform delivery and control.

Bridge: outward admission against inward delivery

Outward lawsuit position	Inward Seattle policy fact	Bridge
SPS says social-media companies should be accountable for harm to students' social, emotional, and mental health. Source: SPS Social Media Case, lines 268-271.	SPS issues each student a digital device and uses district-assigned devices for instruction, assignments, and assessments. Source: 2022SP, lines 274-296.	The district accepts youth platform harm when suing outward while requiring the digital pathway inward.
SPS says companies target/market to young people and create harmful digital environments. Source: SPS Social Media Case, lines 282-289.	SPS network includes blogs, websites, collaboration software, social networking sites, and wikis. Source: 2022SP, lines 311-320.	The school imports platform-style functions into the compulsory school setting.
SPS names increased screen time, unfiltered content, and potentially addictive properties as negative impacts. Source: SPS Social Media Case, lines 297-299.	SPS says filters are not 100 percent effective and are not a solution by themselves. Source: 2022SP, lines 345-352.	The risk is not solved by the filter box; the district knows the control layer is incomplete.
AP reports Seattle alleged that platforms exploit vulnerable youth brains and hook students into feedback loops. Source: AP News, lines 1773-1779.	SPS permits student content production, social-network-like participation, and online publication of student work. Source: 2022SP, lines 317-320.	The relevant school-side question is not whether Seattle is a platform company; it is whether Seattle invited platform logic into school operations.
SPS seeks resources for costs schools bear from student mental/emotional health needs. Source: SPS Social Media Case, lines 289-305.	SPS reserves monitoring/inspection power and discipline consequences for electronic-resource violations. Source: 2022SP, lines 377-410.	The district keeps control and consequence authority inside the required pathway.

Hard bridge sentence

Seattle is a clean exhibit because both halves are public: the district sued outward on platform targeting, youth vulnerability, unfiltered content, and addictive properties; its own electronic-resources procedure shows inward compulsory delivery through district-issued devices, no opt-out/substitution, social-network-like tools, publication, monitoring, incomplete filtering, and discipline.

Category-by-category Seattle proof

1. Device policy

Each student is issued a district digital device. The device may be used for instruction, assessment, out-of-class assignments, and remote learning. Students may be told to bring it home and return with it. Source: 2022SP, lines 274-277.

School-side function: delivery.

2. No opt-out / no substitution

District-assigned devices are used for classroom instruction, assignments, and assessments. Seattle says students cannot opt out of receiving a district device or substitute a personal device. Source: 2022SP, lines 294-296.

School-side function: compulsion/refusal barrier.

3. Acceptable-use gate

Seattle allows educational use but prohibits pornographic, graphically violent, or sexually inappropriate material for non-educational purposes and sexually explicit messages. Source: 2022SP, lines 323-330.

School-side function: known sexual-content risk and consequence coding.

4. Publication/content creation

Acceptable use includes camera images, digital projects, videos, webpages, podcasts, blogs, wikis, social networking groups, and online publication of student work with parental permission. Source: 2022SP, lines 317-320.

School-side function: identity/content/audience pathway.

5. Collaboration/social-network-like tools

Seattle defines its network to include e-mail and Internet content such as blogs, websites, collaboration software, social networking sites, and wikis. Source: 2022SP, lines 311-313.

School-side function: platform logic invited in.

6. Monitoring

Seattle says staff must reasonably monitor student use and the district may monitor student use of the district network on personal or district-provided devices. Source: 2022SP, lines 347-352. It also reserves inspection/review/storage rights over files, applications, e-mail, Internet access, and transmitted/received information. Source: 2022SP, lines 377-387.

School-side function: claimed operational control.

7. Filtering not foolproof

Seattle says filtering is not 100 percent effective and filters are not a solution by themselves. Source: 2022SP, lines 345-352.

School-side function: admitted incomplete control.

8. Discipline consequences

Seattle says electronic-resource violations can cause discipline, including suspension/revocation of access, school suspension, and civil/criminal actions when warranted. Source: 2022SP, lines 408-410.

School-side function: burden/consequence coding.

9. Outward social-media lawsuit

Seattle states it sued companies operating TikTok, Instagram, Facebook, Snapchat, and YouTube to address practices harmful to young people, and described youth as vulnerable consumers. Source: SPS Social Media Case, lines 268-299.

School-side function: outward admission of youth platform-harm logic.

Wrong absorbing boxes to block

Wrong box	Why it fails for this packet
Content filtering	Seattle itself says filtering is not 100 percent effective and is not a solution by itself. The issue is school delivery, not only blocking.
Online safety / digital citizenship	Those labels train the child after the pathway is already required. They do not erase device delivery, no opt-out, network functions, monitoring, or discipline.
Platform-only harm	Seattle sued platforms outward, but its own procedure shows platform-like functions invited inward into school operations.
Student misuse	The student is required to use district devices/resources for instruction, assignments, and assessments before misuse/consequence coding appears.
Parent supervision	The district bars substitution of a personal device and controls district devices, network access, monitoring, and school consequences.
Privacy compliance	Monitoring and data privacy are control evidence; they do not answer what child-facing pathway the school created.

OCR / school-control use

Use this packet to show the school-side owner function from public materials: Seattle controls entry, device, network, electronic-resource conditions, publication tools, monitoring, incomplete filtering, and discipline. That is the school-control bridge; it does not require a CPRA request at the first layer.

OCR sentence:

The district's public policies show that it required the electronic-resource pathway, did not permit opt-out/substitution, imported collaboration/social-network-like and publication tools, admitted filtering limits, monitored student use, and retained discipline authority; the district's outward lawsuit shows it already recognizes youth platform harm when the arrow points outward.

Source list

No.	Source	What it supports
1	Seattle Public Schools, 2022SP Electronic Resources/Use of the Internet. URL: https://www.seattleschools.org/about/school-board/policies/2022sp-electronic-resources-use-of-the-internet/	Device issuance; no opt-out/substitution; network functions; acceptable/unacceptable use; publication; filtering/monitoring; discipline.
2	Seattle Public Schools, Board Policy 2022 Electronic Resources/Use of the Internet. URL: https://www.seattleschools.org/about/school-board/policies/2022-electronic-resources-use-of-the-internet/	Board-level policy: electronic educational systems, Internet safety, non-guarantee against objectionable material, filtering, supervision, instruction.
3	Seattle Public Schools, Social Media Complaint Filed by Seattle Public Schools. URL: https://www.seattleschools.org/news/social-media-case/	Outward admission: social-media platform practices harmful to students; youth vulnerability; unfiltered content; potentially addictive properties; school costs/resources.
4	Associated Press, Seattle schools sue tech giants over social media harm. URL: https://apnews.com/article/social-media-seattle-lawsuits-mental-health-965a8f373e3bfed8157571912cc3b542	Independent public report summarizing Seattle complaint, public nuisance theory, feedback-loop allegation, school education burden, and requested relief.

Notes on method

This packet uses only public web sources. It does not use uploaded files or CPRA/public-records responses. I did not locate a Seattle BoardDocs source in the public search results; Seattle's own policy/procedure pages and public lawsuit page were used as the district sources.